

Ingesting Sysmon Data into Microsoft Sentinel

A step-by-step walkthrough covering Sysmon fundamentals, workspace setup, agent onboarding, and log ingestion into Sentinel via Defender's unified portal.

1. Overview: What Is Sysmon?

Sysmon (System Monitor) is a Windows Sysinternals tool — also ported to Linux — that installs as a system service and driver to log detailed system activity to the Windows Event Log, well beyond what native Windows auditing captures out of the box.

Key events it logs, each as a distinct Event ID:

Event ID	Description
1	Process creation (full command line, hashes, parent process, user)
3	Network connections
5	Process termination
6	Driver loaded
7	Image/DLL loaded
8	CreateRemoteThread (classic injection indicator)
10	ProcessAccess (e.g., LSASS access — credential dumping detection)
11	File created
12/13/14	Registry create / modify / delete / rename
22	DNS query
23	File delete (archived)

Sysmon is driven by an XML configuration file where you define rule-based include/exclude filters, so you're not drowning in noise — for example, you can exclude known-noisy processes like `svchost.exe` writing to certain registry paths,

while explicitly tracking things like PowerShell or `rundll32` spawning child processes.

Why it matters for blue team work: native Windows Security auditing (Event ID 4688 for process creation, for example) is comparatively shallow — no hashes, weaker parent-child context. Sysmon is what makes KQL hunting queries for things like LOLBins abuse, process injection, or suspicious parent-child chains (e.g., `winword.exe` spawning `powershell.exe`) actually viable in Sentinel/Defender.

Sysmon writes events under `Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational` in Event Viewer. These get forwarded into Sentinel typically via the Azure Monitor Agent (AMA) with a Data Collection Rule (DCR) pulling from that channel, or via Windows Event Forwarding (WEF) centralizing it first. On the Linux port, similar concepts (`execve` , network connect, etc.) map to the same event schema, though the event set is smaller than on Windows.

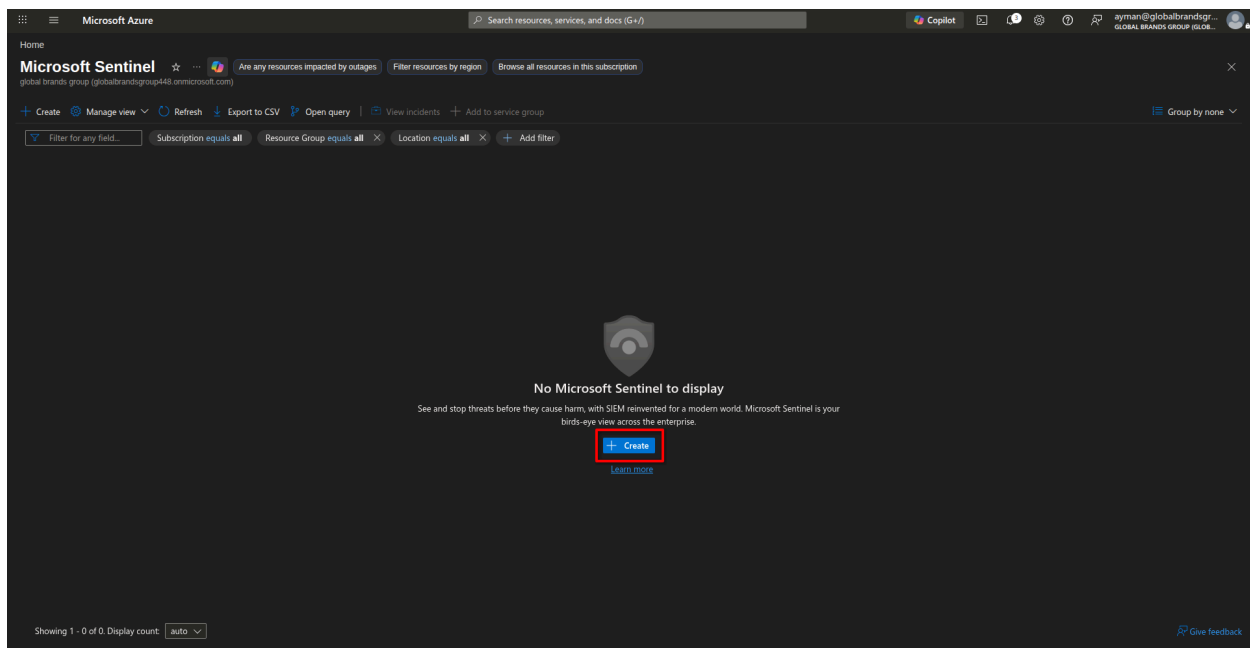
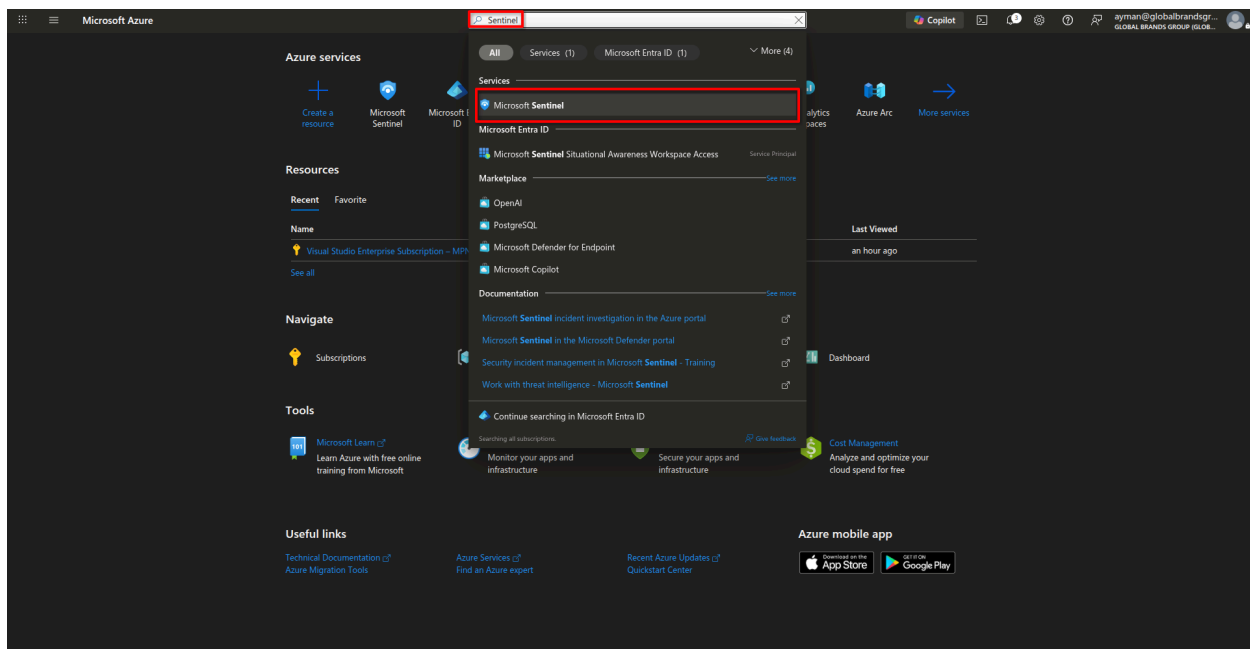
2. Prerequisites

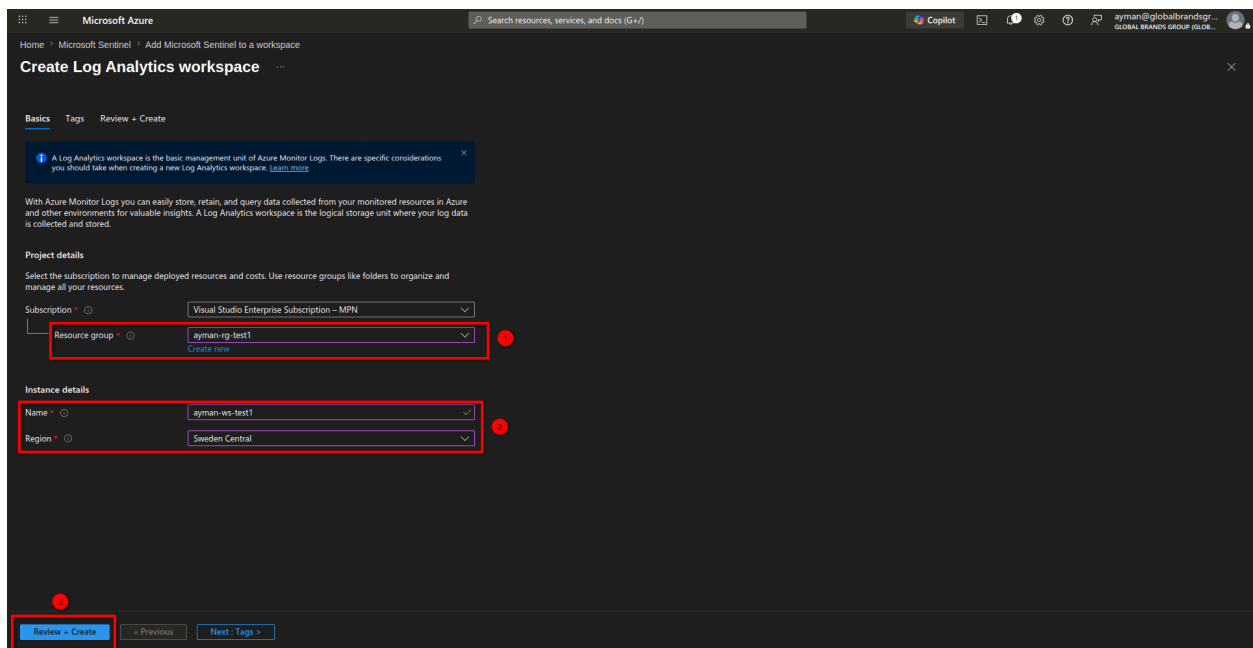
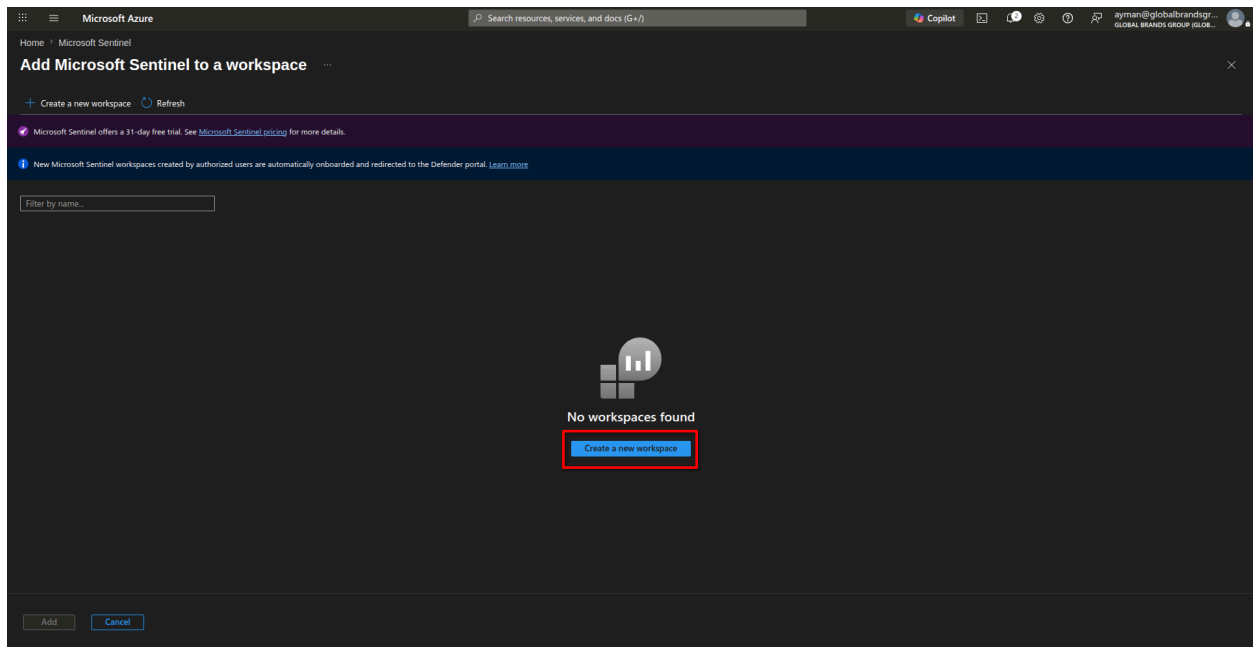
- A Windows machine to monitor (local admin/elevated PowerShell access)
 - An Azure subscription and resource group
 - Permissions to create a Log Analytics Workspace and onboard Azure Arc resources
-

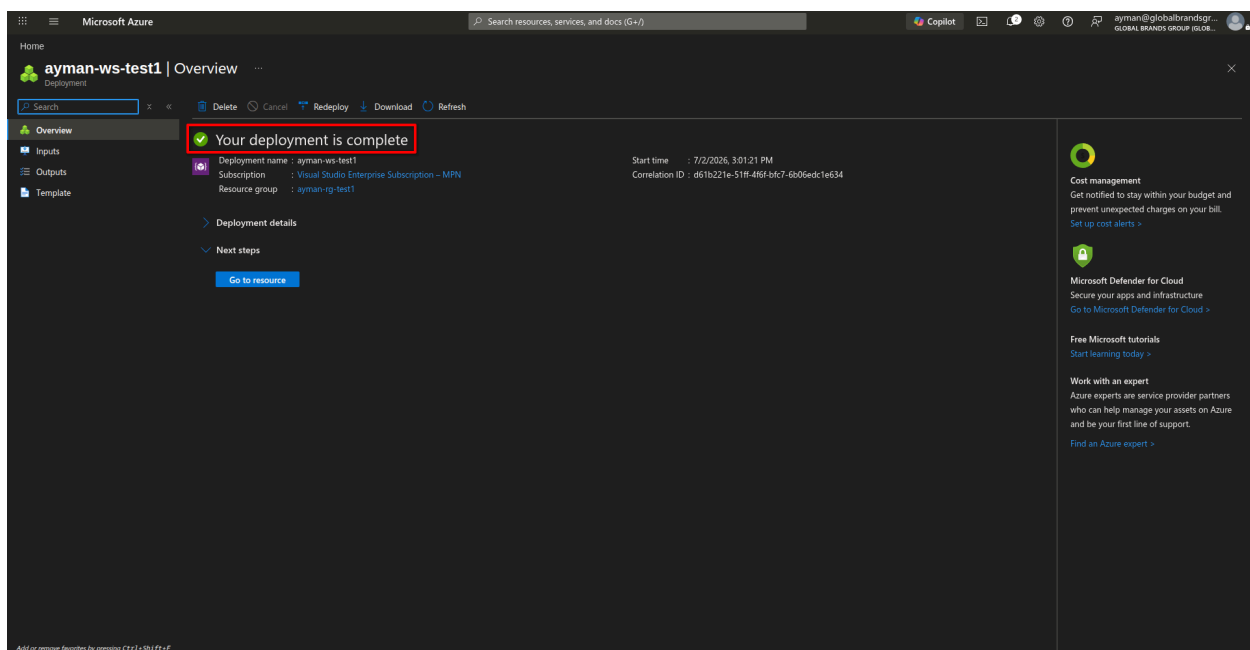
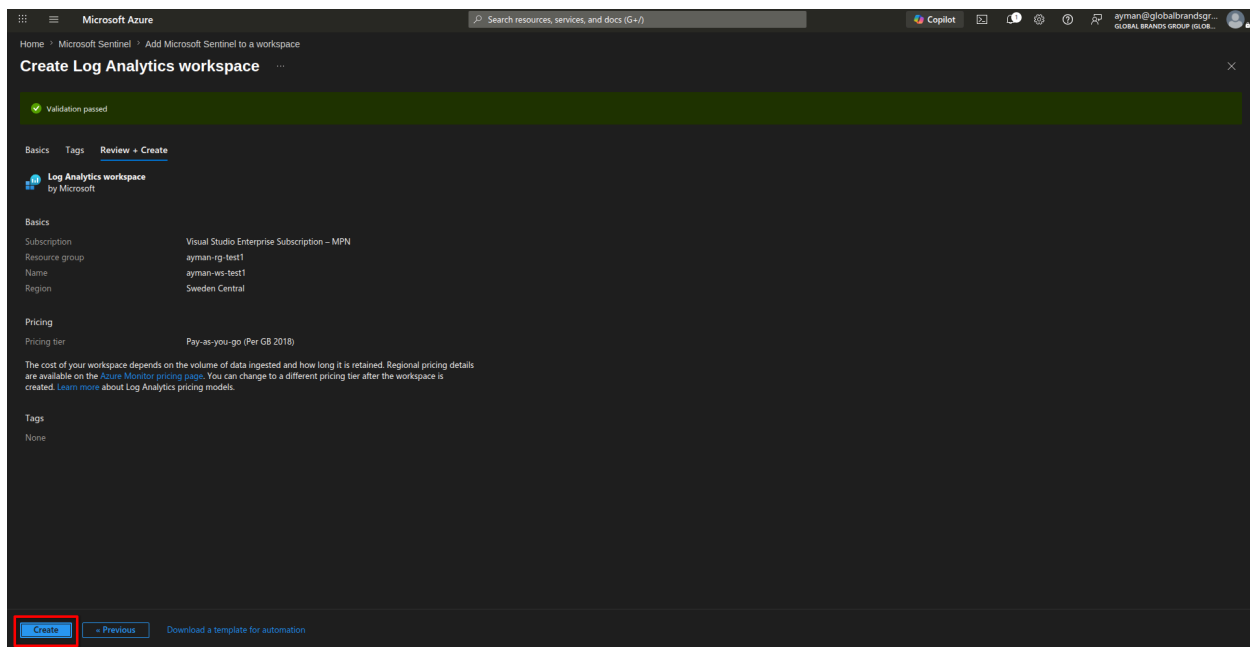
3. Create the Sentinel Workspace

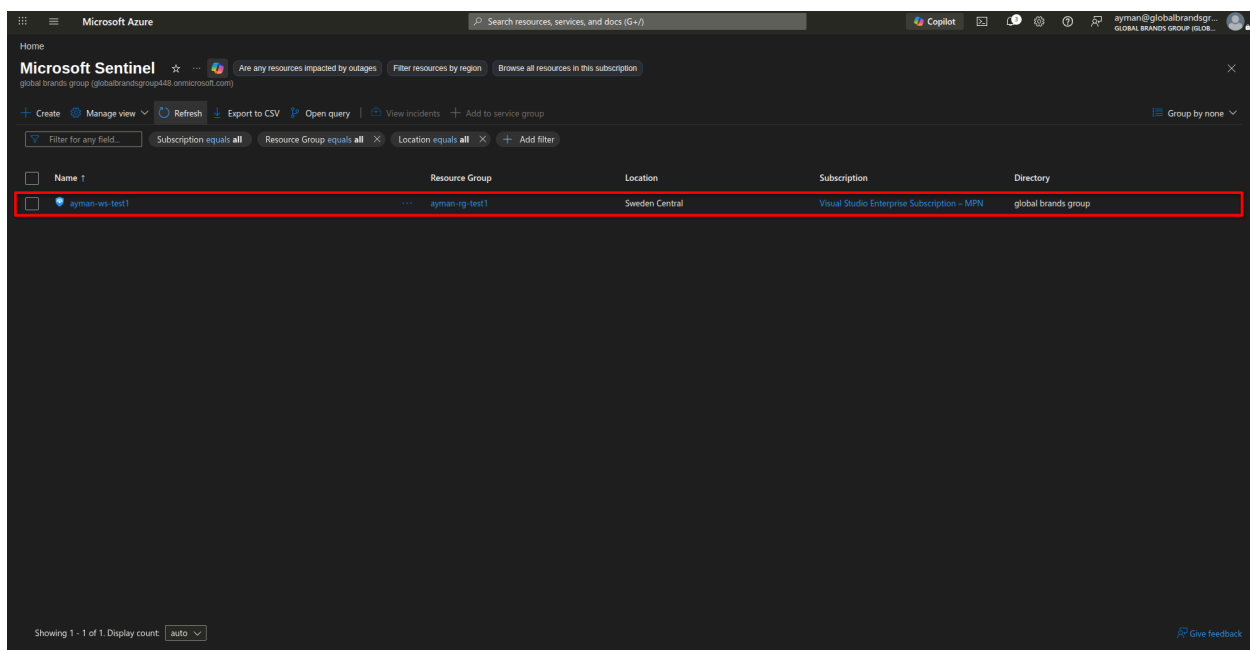
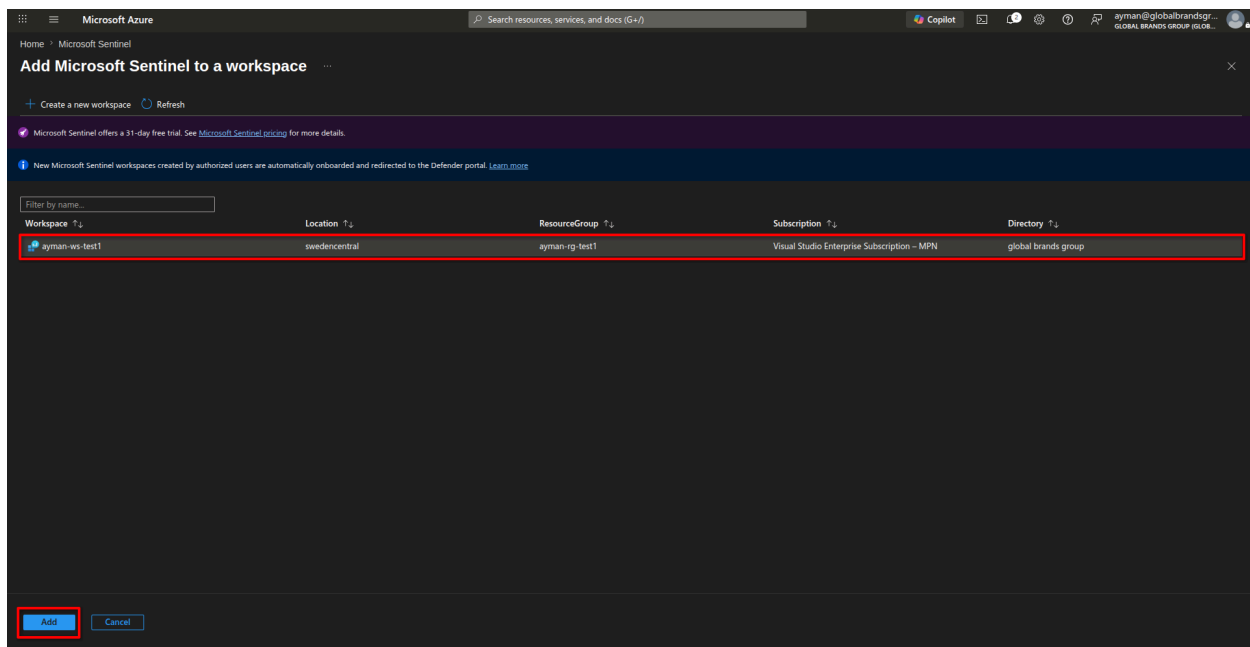
Sentinel runs on top of a Log Analytics Workspace, so this needs to exist before anything else is connected.

1. In the Azure Portal, create a new **Log Analytics Workspace**.
2. Assign it to your **resource group**, and choose a **workspace name** and **region**.
3. Enable Microsoft Sentinel on top of that workspace.









The workspace is now created and ready to receive data.

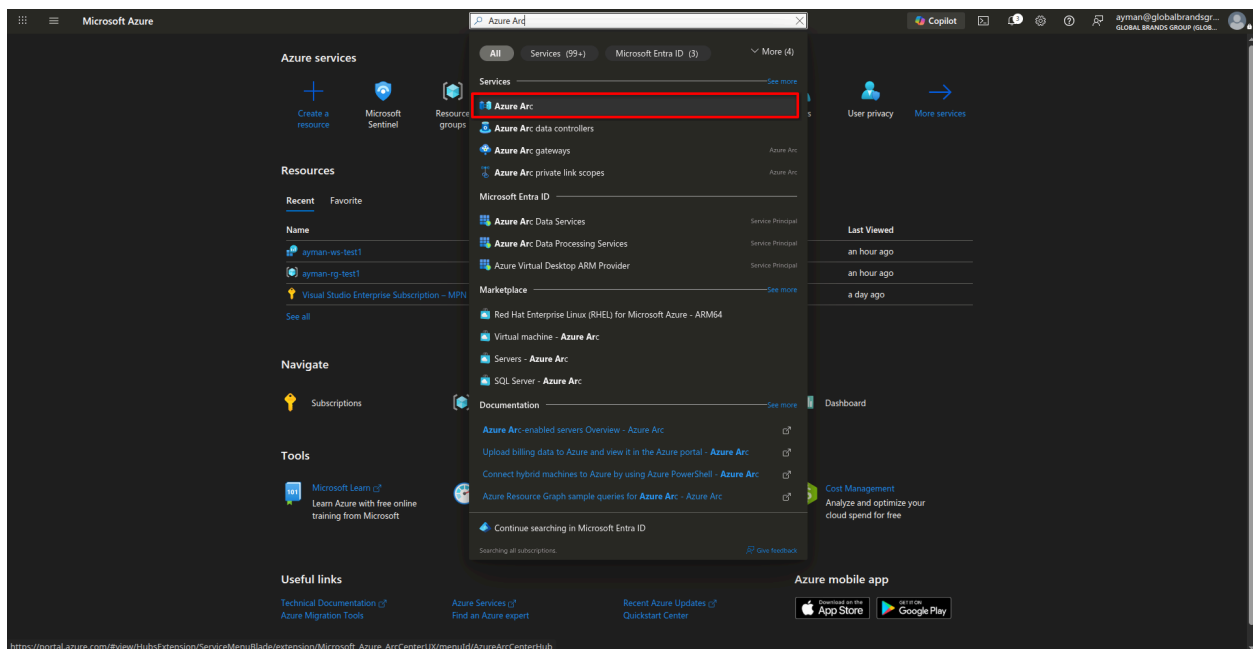
4. Onboard the Machine via Azure Arc

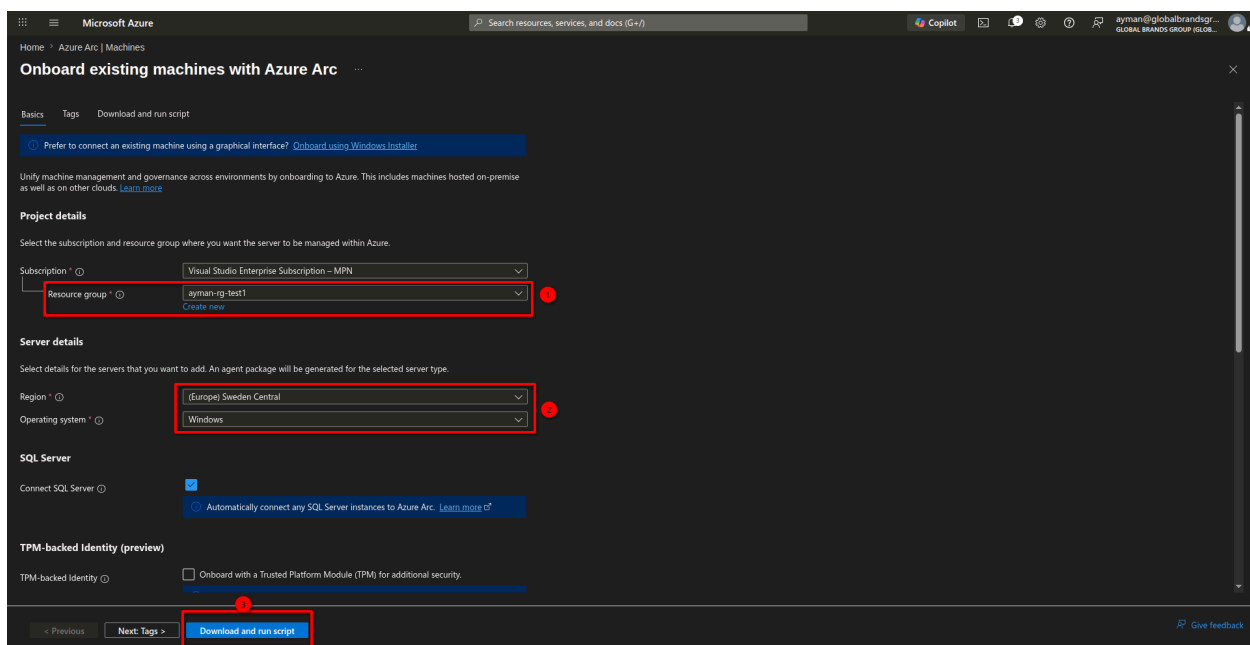
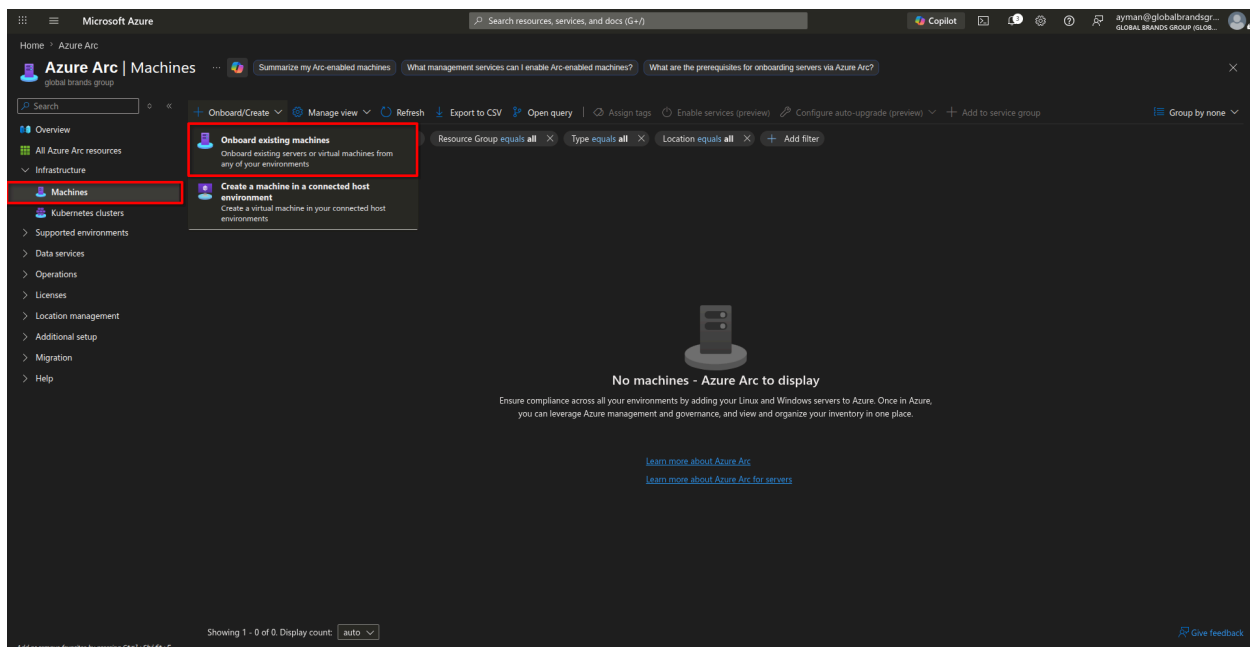
Azure Arc extends Azure management to the on-prem/VM machine so it can be targeted by Data Collection Rules.

1. In the Azure Portal, go to **Azure Arc** → add a new machine.
2. Select your **resource group**, **region**, and **OS**.
3. Download the generated onboarding script and run it on the Windows machine.
4. If PowerShell blocks the script, run:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope CurrentUser
```

5. Sign in with your Microsoft account when prompted. Once the script completes, the machine is Arc-onboarded.
6. Confirm it by checking your resource group — the machine should now appear as an Arc-connected resource.





Microsoft Azure

Home > Azure Arc > Machines

Onboard existing machines with Azure Arc

Basics Tags Download and run script

1. Download or copy the following script

```

17 }
18
19 try {
20     if (-not ([Security.Principal.WindowsPrincipal] [Security.Principal.WindowsIdentity]::GetCurrent)
21         .GetType().FullName -eq "System.Security.Principal.WindowsIdentity") {
22         if ($System.Environment).UserInteractive {
23             Restart-AsAdmin
24         } else {
25             throw "This script requires administrator permissions to install the Azure Connected Machine Agent"
26         }
27     }
28
29     $env:SUBSCRIPTION_ID = "68ba34d6-e952-486b-b38d-a3189360cd74";
30     $env:RESOURCE_GROUP = "ayman-rg-test1";
31     $env:TENANT_ID = "c75c9852-d540-4fa5-914d-bf02683d7575";
32     $env:LOCATION = "swedencentral";
33     $env:AUTH_TYPE = "token";
34     $env:CORRELATION_ID = "6d2828eb-1578-45ad-a84a-2c21d818d55c";
35     $env:CLOUD = "AzureCloud";
36
37     [Net.ServicePointManager]::SecurityProtocol = [Net.ServicePointManager]::SecurityProtocol -bor TLS12
38
39     $azcmagentPath = Join-Path $env:SystemRoot "AzureConnectedMachineAgent"
40     if (-not (Test-Path -Path $azcmagentPath)) {
41         New-Item -Path $azcmagentPath -ItemType Directory
42         Write-Output "Directory $azcmagentPath created"
43     }
44
45     $tempPath = Join-Path $azcmagentPath "temp"
46     if (-not (Test-Path -Path $tempPath)) {
47         New-Item -Path $tempPath -ItemType Directory
48     }
49 }
50
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```

[Download](#)

2. Open a PowerShell console to run the script

< Previous Next Close

Give feedback

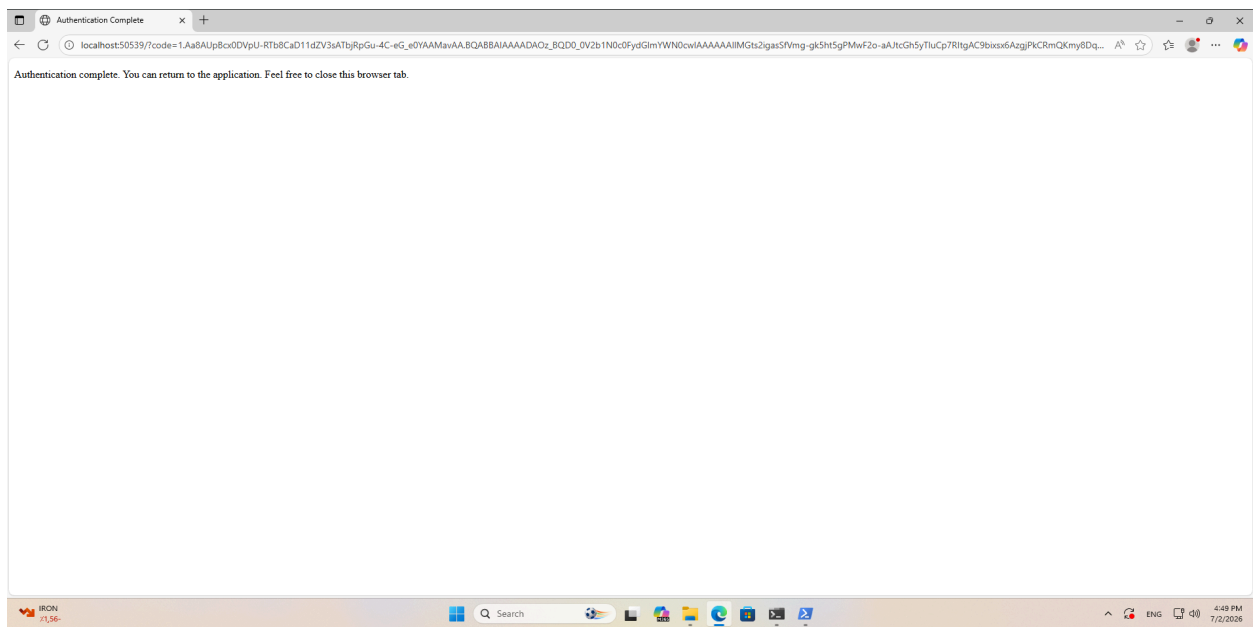
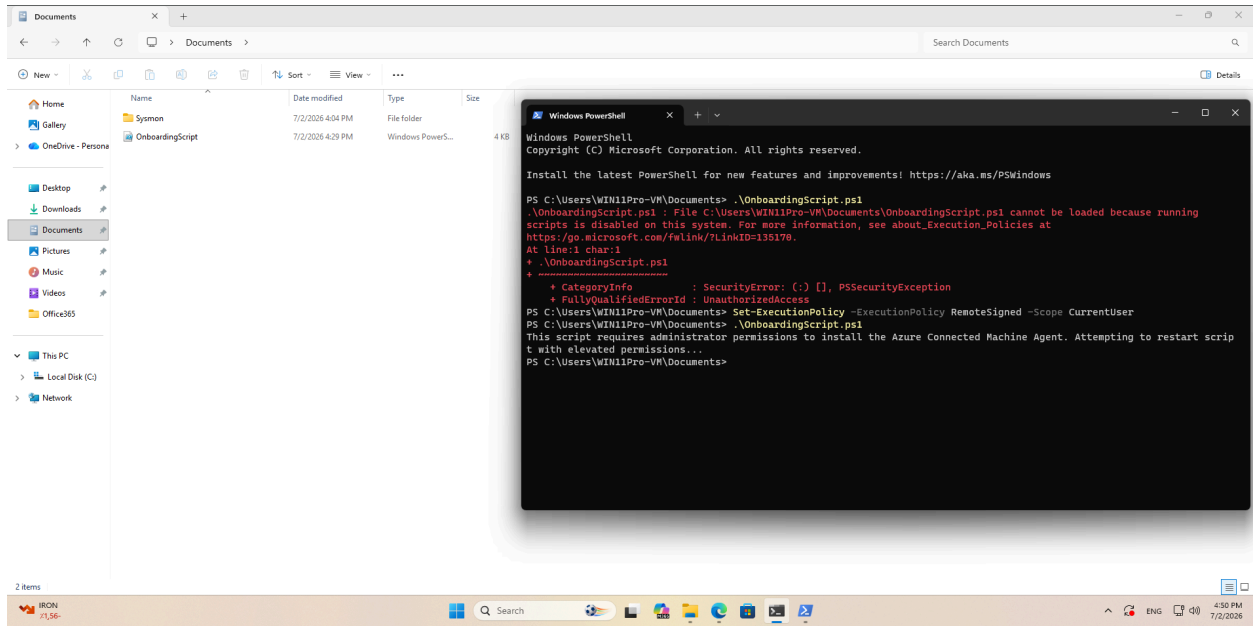
Documents

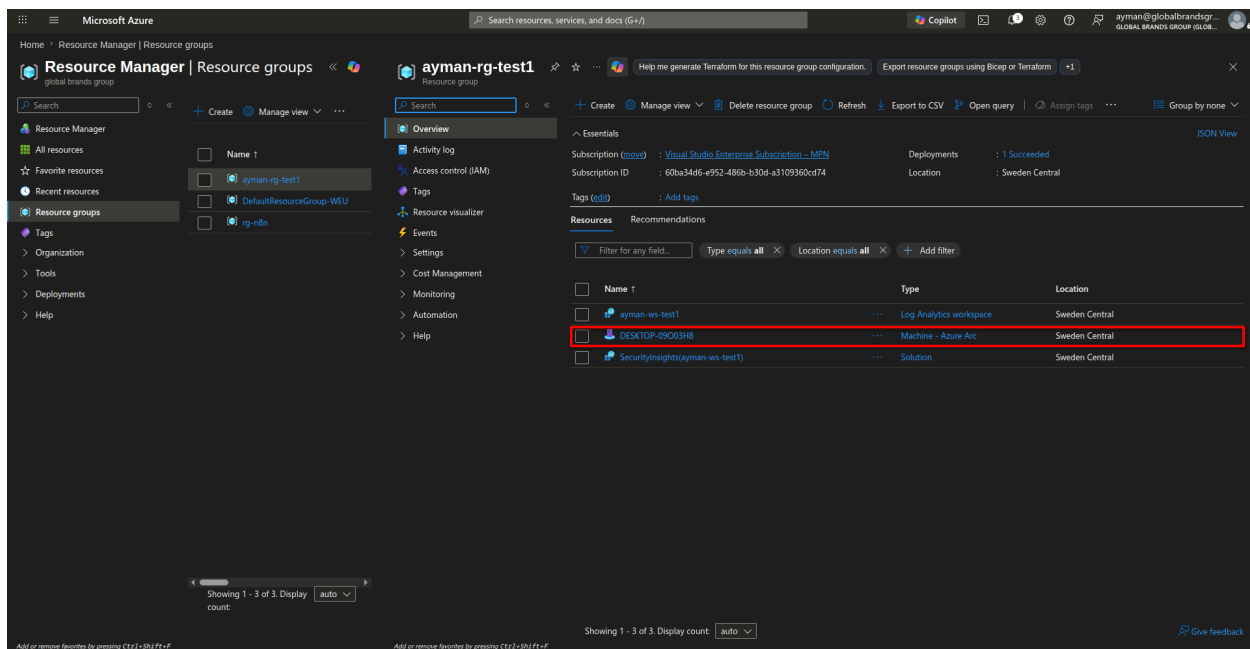
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Name	Date modified	Type	Size
Sysmon	7/2/2026 4:04 PM	File folder	
OnboardingScript	7/2/2026 4:29 PM	Windows PowerShell script	4 KB

2 Items

35°C 4:30 PM 7/2/2026





5. Install Sysmon on the Target Machine

1. **Download Sysmon** from Microsoft Sysinternals:

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/sysinternals/downloads/sysmon>

Or via winget:

```
winget install Microsoft.Sysinternals.Sysmon
```

2. **Get a configuration file** — don't run Sysmon with defaults, they're too sparse. The community standard is Olaf Hartong's SwiftOnSecurity-based config, or the original SwiftOnSecurity config:

- <https://github.com/olafhartong/sysmon-modular>
- <https://github.com/SwiftOnSecurity/sysmon-config>

Copy the contents and save them as `sysmonconfiguration.xml`.

3. **Install Sysmon as a service** (elevated PowerShell/CMD):

```
.\Sysmon64.exe -accepteula -i sysmonconfiguration.xml
```

4. Verify the service is running:

Get-Service Sysmon64

5. Check the log source in Event Viewer:

Applications and Services Logs > Microsoft > Windows > Sysmon > Operational

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Sysmon v15.21

Summarize this article for me

By Mark Russinovich and Thomas Garnier

Published: June 17, 2026

Download Sysmon (4.6 MB)

Download Sysmon for Linux (GitHub)

Introduction

System Monitor (Sysmon) is a Windows system service and device driver that, once installed on a system, remains resident across system reboots to monitor and log system activity to the Windows event log. It provides detailed information about process creations, network connections, and changes to file creation time. By collecting the events it generates using Windows Event Collection or SIEM agents and subsequently analyzing them, you can identify malicious or anomalous activity and understand how intruders and malware operate on your network. The service runs as a protected process, thus disallowing a wide range of user mode

In this article

- Introduction
- Overview of Sysmon Capabilities
- Screenshots
- Usage
- Examples
- Events
- Configuration files
- Configuration Entries
- Event filtering entries

Dolphin 22 min remaining

Copying 10 of 14 files to VentoyTest 36%

Details Pause Cancel

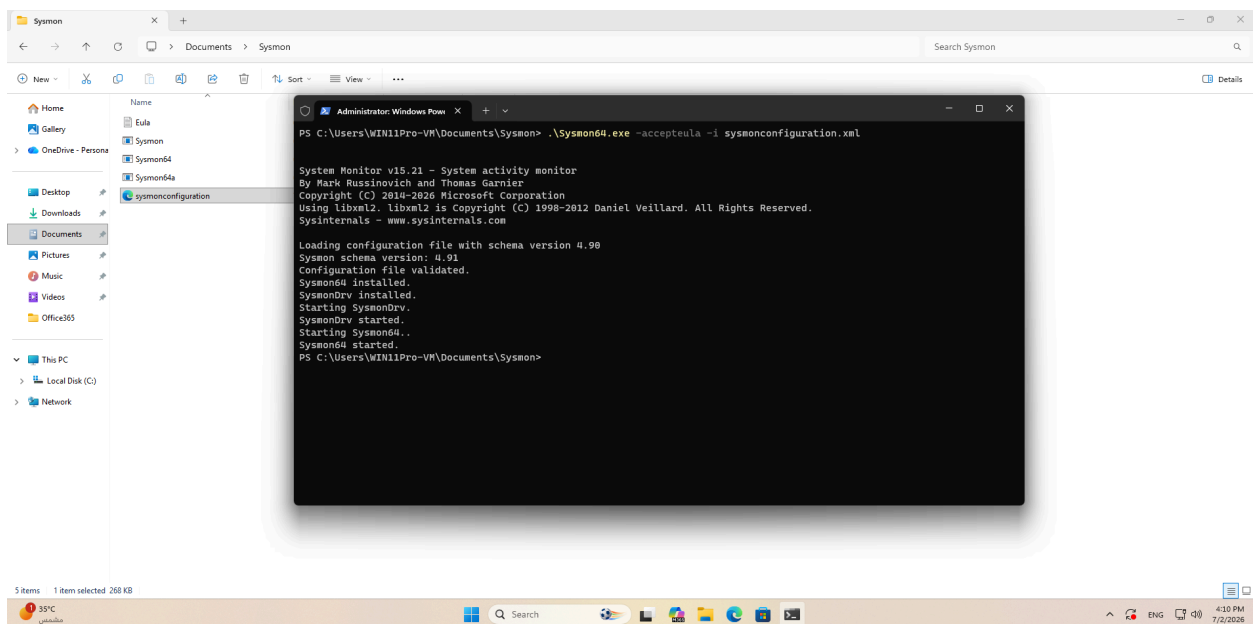
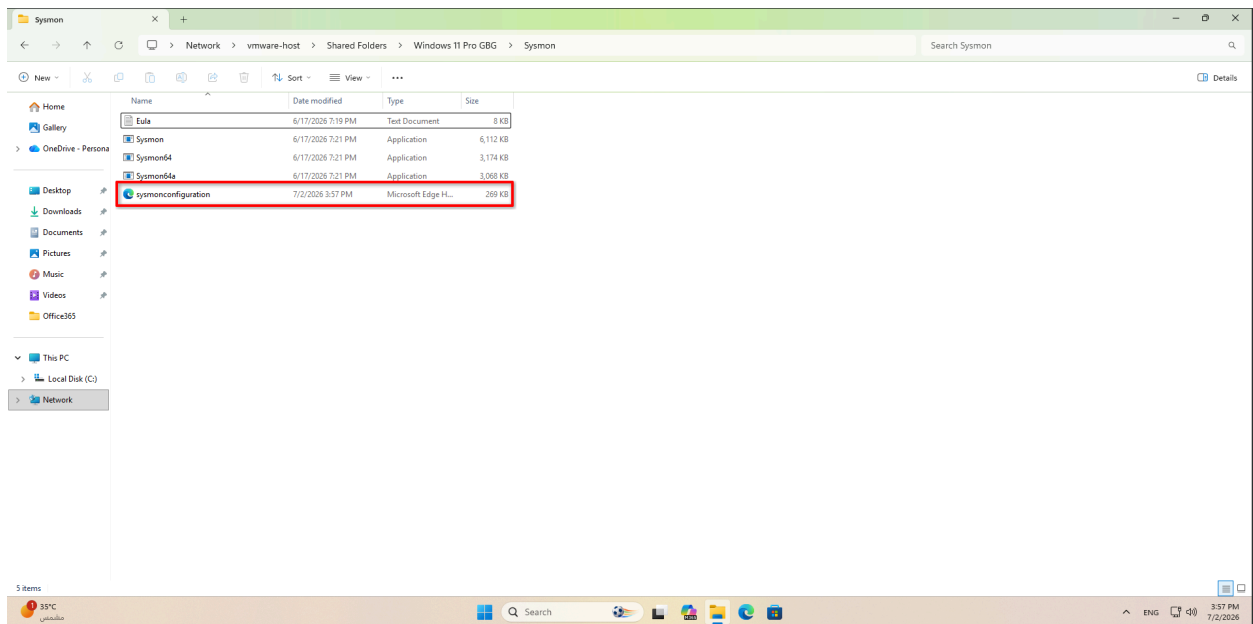
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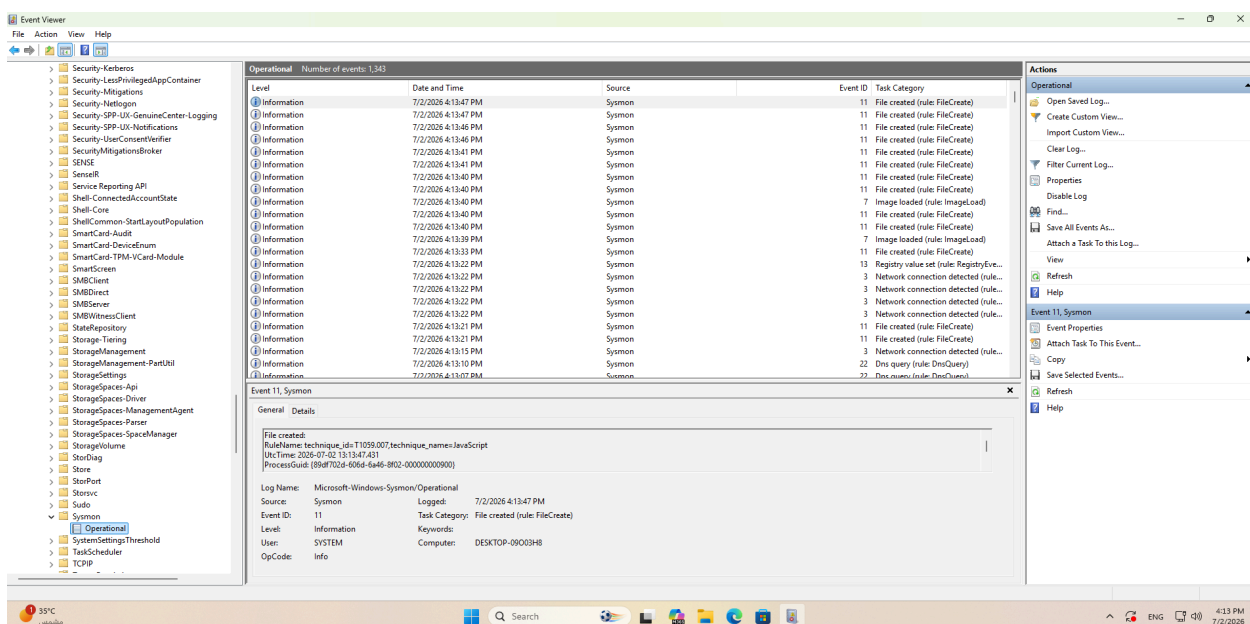
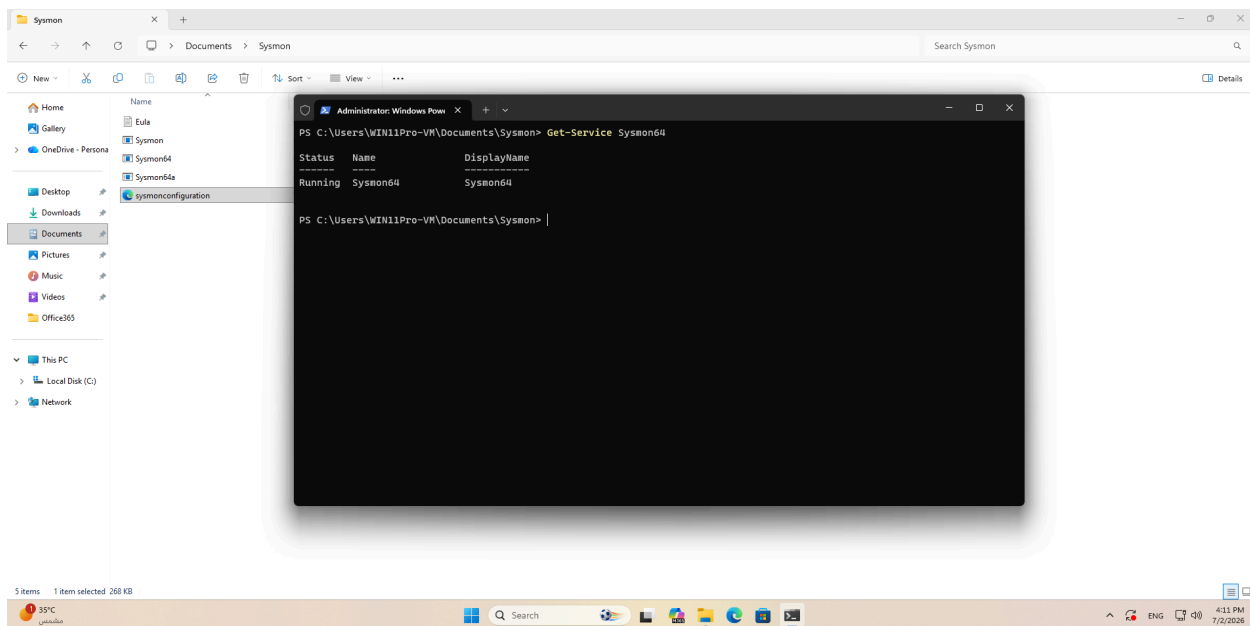
Never to get even more value out of the framework even, consider getting the most up-to-date version of the LOLdrivers config merged into the config as well. You can easily do that by grabbing the file and adding it in the 29_file_execute_detected folder and generate a new config.

The sysmonconfig.xml within the repo is automatically generated after a successful merge by the PowerShell script and a successful load by Sysmon in an Azure Pipeline run. More info on how to generate a custom config, incorporating your own modules [here](#)

Pre-Generated configurations

Type	Config	Description
default	sysmonconfig.xml	This is the balanced configuration, most used, more information here
default+	sysmonconfig-with-filedelete.xml	This is the balanced configuration, most used, more information including FileDelete file saves
verbose	sysmonconfig-excludes-only.xml	This is the very verbose configuration, all events are included, only the exclusion modules are applied. This should not be used in production without validation, will generate a significant amount of data and might impact performance. More information here
super verbose	sysmonconfig-research.xml	A configuration with extreme verbosity. The log volume expected from this file is significantly high, really DO NOT USE IN PRODUCTION! This config is only for research, this will use way more CPU/Memory. Only enable prior to running the to be investigated technique, when done load a lighter config.
MDE augment	sysmonconfig-mde-augmentation.xml	A configuration to augment Defender for Endpoint, intended to augment the information and have as little overlap as possible. This is based on the default/balanced config and will not generate all events for Sysmon, there are comments in the config. In the benefit of IR consider using the excludes only config and only ingest the





6. Customize Which Events Sysmon Captures (Optional)

You can tailor Sysmon's config to scope collection to specific events — useful for controlled testing or reducing noise further than the base community config.

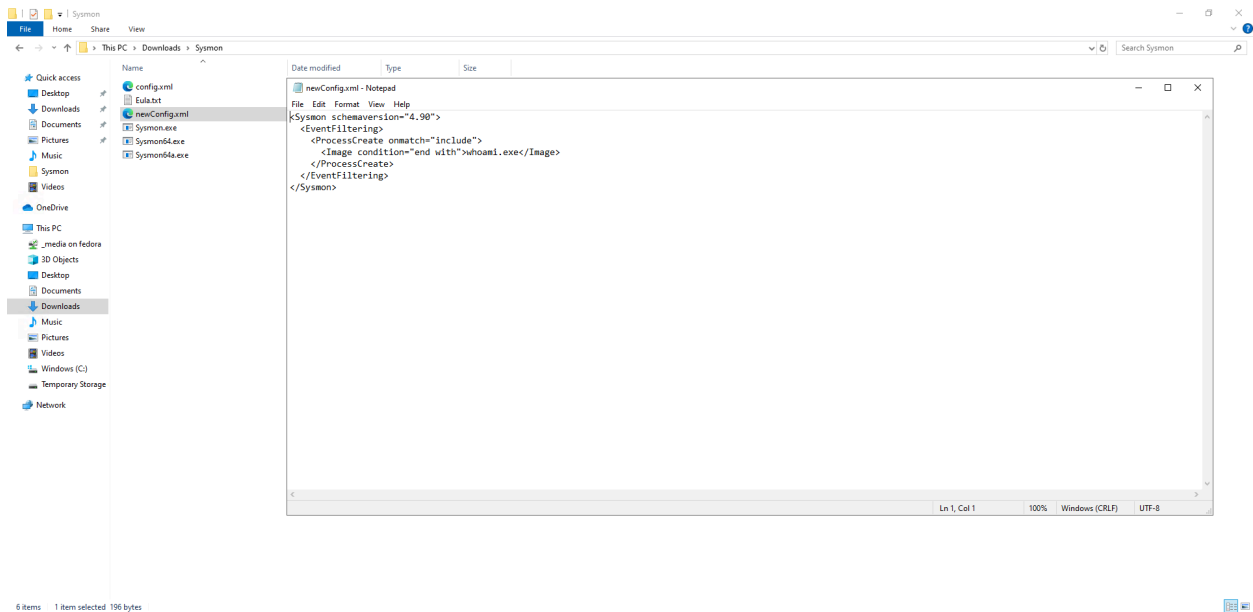
Example — capture only `whoami.exe` process creation:

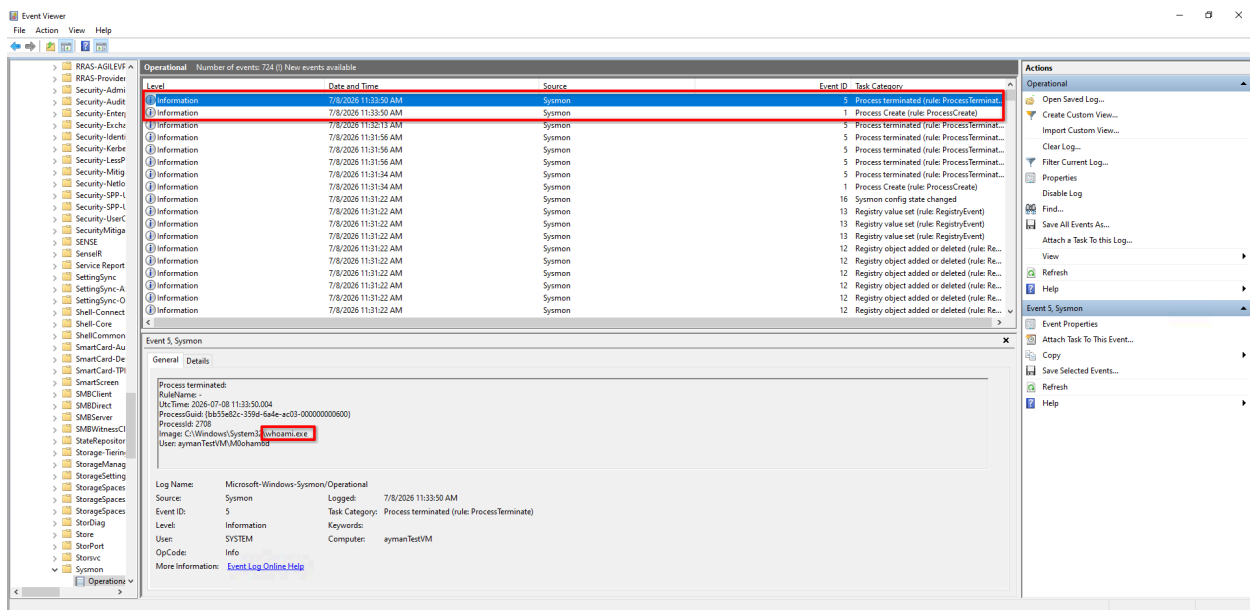
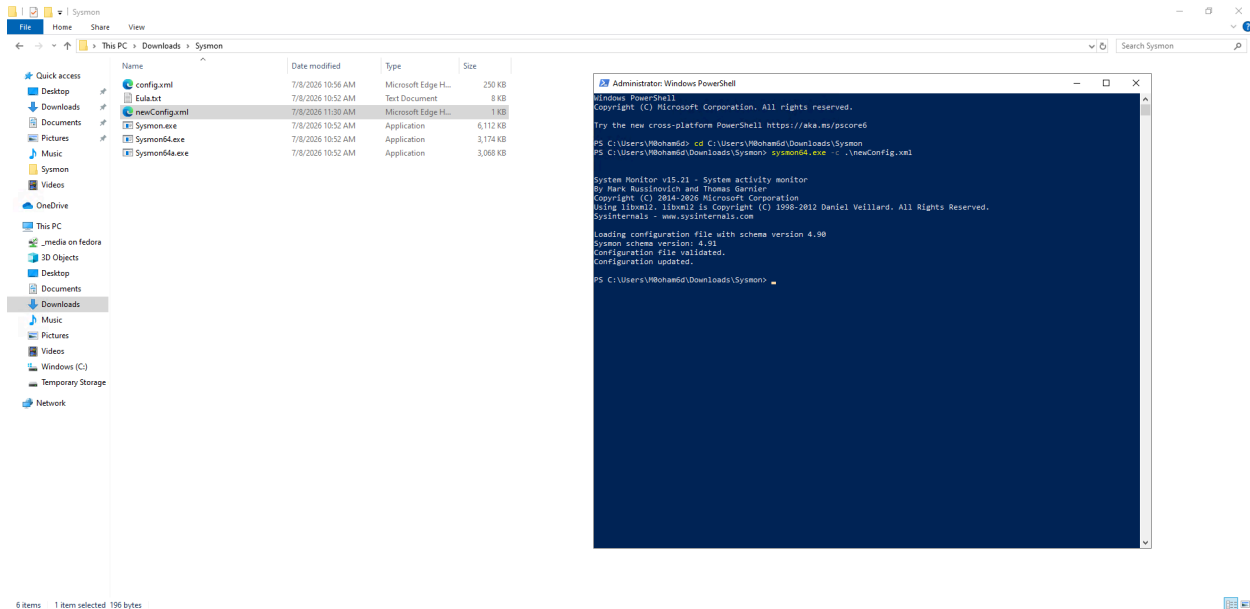
```
<Sysmon schemaversion="4.90">
  <EventFiltering>
    <ProcessCreate onmatch="include">
      <Image condition="end with">whoami.exe</Image>
    </ProcessCreate>
  </EventFiltering>
</Sysmon>
```

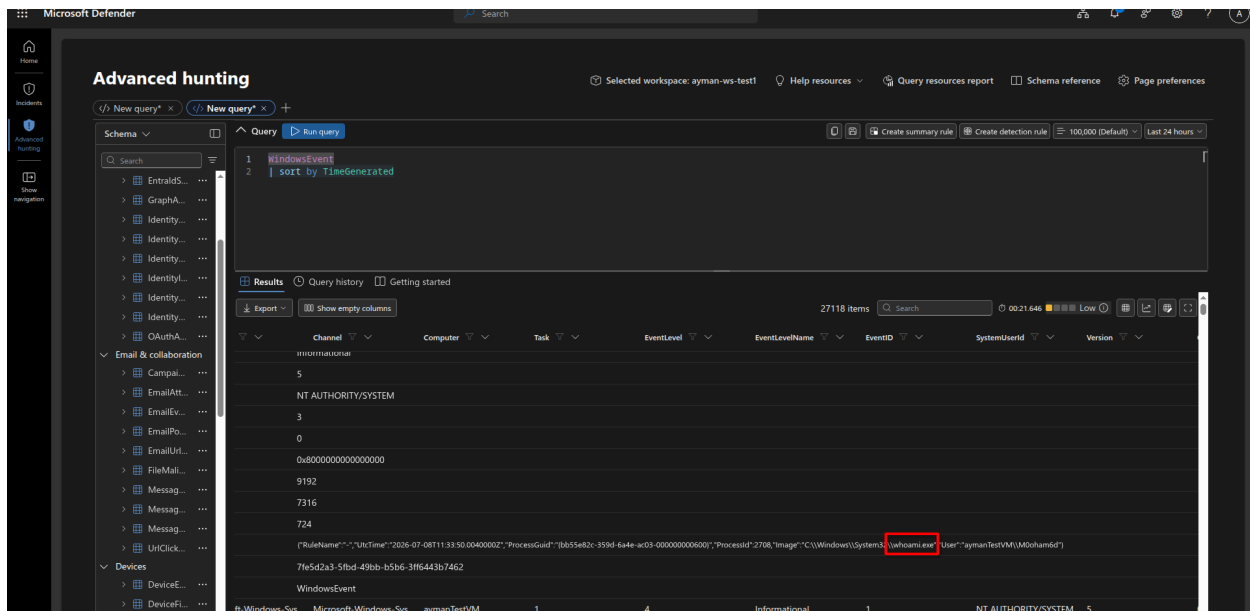
Save this as `newConfig.xml` , then apply it:

```
sysmon64.exe -c .\newConfig.xml
```

After this, Event Viewer will only show process-creation events matching that filter, and the same scoped results will appear in Advanced Hunting once ingestion is set up (Section 8).







7. Connect Data Sources in Sentinel / Defender

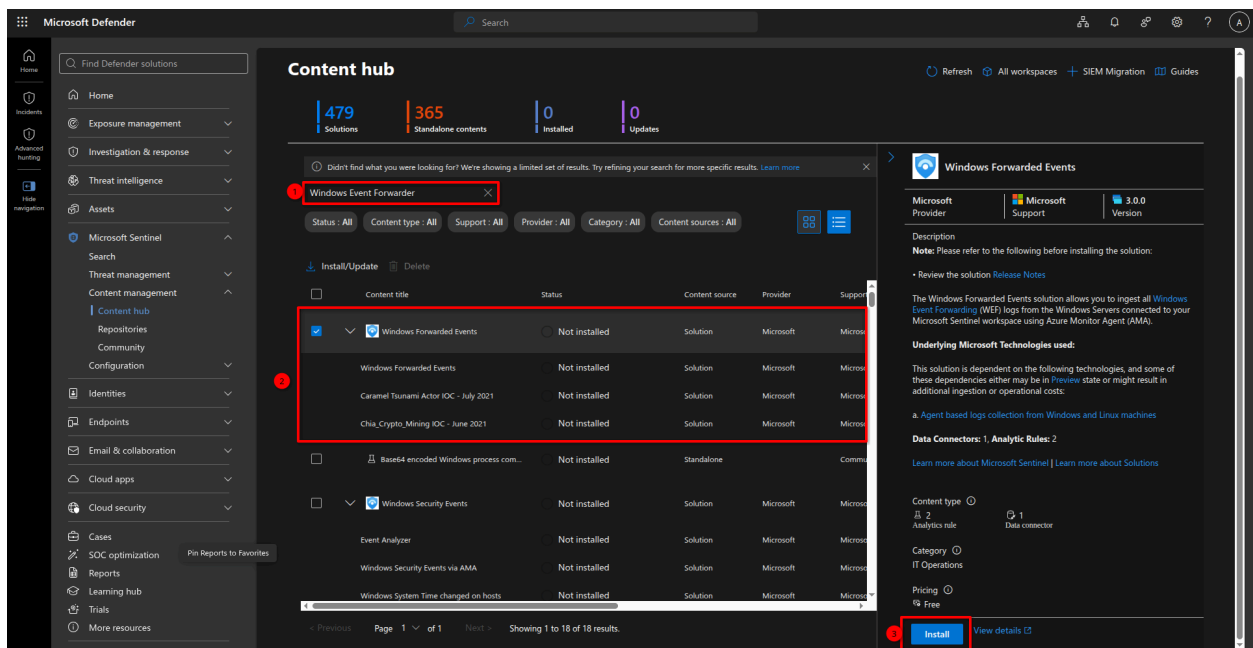
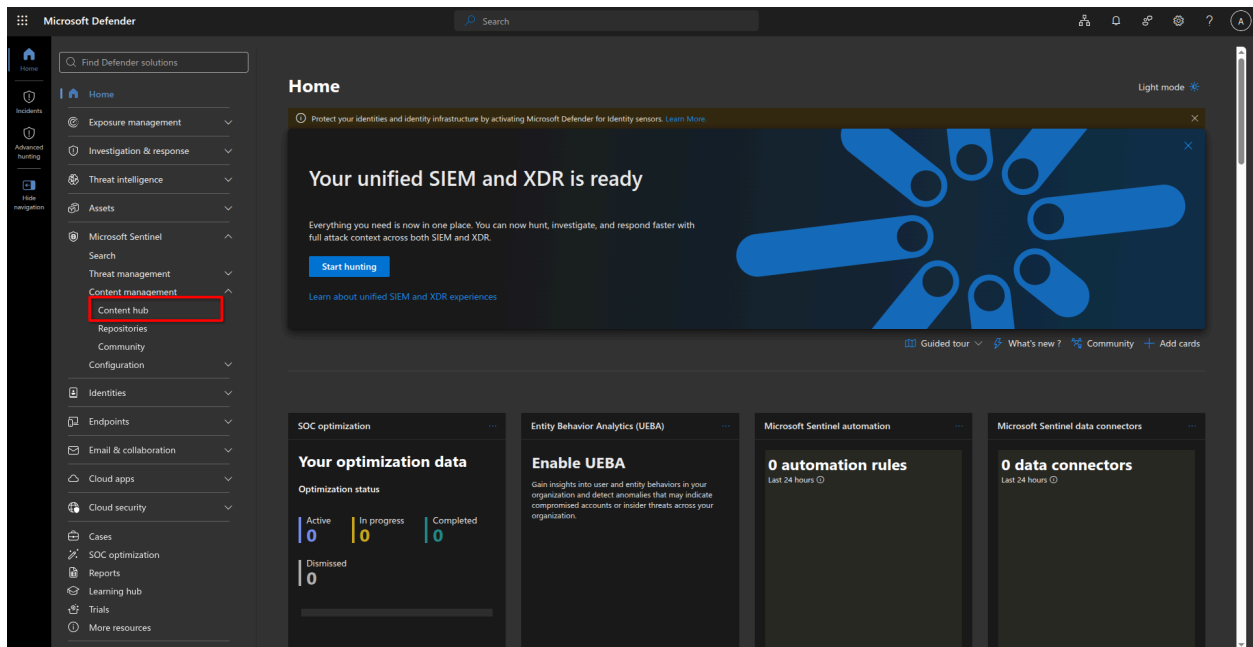
With the workspace live, the machine Arc-onboarded, and Sysmon installed, the next step is telling Sentinel what to ingest.

7.1 Collect Sysmon Events

1. Go to the Defender Portal: security.microsoft.com
2. Open **Content Hub** and install **Windows Event Forwarder**.
3. Go to **Data Connectors** → **Windows Event Forwarder**.
4. Create a new **DCR (Data Collection Rule)**:
 - Set its name, subscription, and resource group.
 - Select your Windows machine as the target resource.
 - Specify the log channel to forward:

Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational

5. Click refresh to confirm the DCR rule appears.



Microsoft Defender

Content hub > Windows Forwarded Events > Data connectors

2 Connectors 1 Connected

Search by name or provider Providers: Microsoft

Data Types: All Status: All Updates

Status	Connector name	Updates
Connected	Microsoft 365 Insider Ri...	Microsoft
Disconnected	Windows Forwarded Eve...	Microsoft

Windows Forwarded Events

Disconnected Status Provider Last Log Received

Description: You can stream all Windows Event Forwarding (WEF) logs from the Windows Servers connected to your Microsoft Sentinel workspace using Azure Monitor Agent (AMA). This connection enables you to view dashboards, create custom alerts, and improve investigation. This gives you more insight into your organization's network and improves your security operation capabilities.

Last data received: --

Content source: Windows Forwarded Events Version: 1.0.0

Author: Microsoft Supported by: Microsoft Corporation | Email

Related content: 0 Workbooks 1 Queries 0 Analytics rules templates

Data types: WindowsEvents --

Open connector page

Microsoft Defender

0 Workbooks 1 Queries 2 Analytics rules templates

Data received: Go to log analytics

WindowsEvents

Data types: WindowsEvents --

Configuration

Enable data collection rule

Windows Forwarded Events logs are collected only from Windows agents.

Refresh

Rule name	Created by	Filter name
No results		

Create data collection rule

Asim normalization support - Recommended!

This connector is supported by Asim. Learn more >

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Unconnected Status

Microsoft Provider

Last Log Received

Description

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Last data received

Content source

Version

Windows Forwarded Events

1.0.0

Author

Supported by

Microsoft

Microsoft Corporation

Email

Related content

0 Workbooks

1 Queries

2 Analytics rules templates

Data received

Go to log analytics

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1

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June 26 June 27 June 28 June 29 June 30 July 1 July 2

WindowsEvents

0

Data types

WindowsEvents

Prerequisites

To integrate with Windows Forwarded Events

Workspace data sources: read and write

To collect data from non-Azure VMs, the

Table management

Manage the table tiers - analytics and lake storage settings.

Table name

Tier

WindowsEvent

Analytics

Configuration

Enable data collection rule

Windows Forwarded Events logs are collected

Refresh

Rule name

Create

No results

Create data collection rule

Asim normalization support

This connector is supported by Asim

Deploy

DCR Wizard

Basic Resources Collect Review > create

Select the subscription to manage deployed resources and costs. Use resource groups like folders to organize and manage all of your resources.

Rule details

Rule name

collect-sysmon-logs

Subscription

Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription - ...

Resource group

ayman-rg-test1

Next: Resources >

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Unconnected Status

Microsoft Provider

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Last data received

Content source

Version

Windows Forwarded Events

1.0.0

Author

Supported by

Microsoft

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Email

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1 Queries

2 Analytics rules templates

Data received

Go to log analytics

4

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June 26 June 27 June 28 June 29 June 30 July 1 July 2

WindowsEvents

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Data types

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Refresh

Rule name

Create

No results

Create data collection rule

Asim normalization support

This connector is supported by Asim

Deploy

DCR Wizard

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Resource Groups

Resource Types

Locations

Selected: All

Selected: All

Selected: All

Selected: All

Search to filter items...

Show Selected

Scope

Resource Type

Location

Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription - MPN

ayman-rg-test1

DESKTOP-09003H8

microsoft.hybridcom

Sweden Central

Previous

Next: Collect >

Microsoft Defender

Content hub > Windows Forwarded Events > Data connectors > Connector details

Connector details

Windows Forwarded Events

Status: Disconnected | Provider: Microsoft | Last Log Received: --

Description
You can stream all Windows Event Forwarding (WEF) logs from the Windows Servers connected to your Microsoft Sentinel workspace using Azure Monitor Agent (AMA). This connection enables you to view dashboards, create custom alerts, and improve investigation. This gives you more insight into your organization's network and improves your security operation capabilities.

Last data received
--

Content source
Windows Forwarded Events

Version
1.0.0

Author
Microsoft

Supported by
Microsoft Corporation | Email

Related content
0 Workbooks | 1 Queries | 2 Analytics rules templates

Data received
Go to log analytics

Table management
Manage the table tiers - analytics and lake and settings.

Configuration
Enable data collection rule
Windows Forwarded Events logs are collected only from Windows agents.

DCR Wizard
Basic Resources Collect Review + create
Select which events to stream.
☐ All Forwarded Events ☒ Custom
Each box can contain up to 20 expressions
Microsoft:Windows-Sysmon/Operational*
Add
Event logs
No results

Microsoft Defender

Content hub > Windows Forwarded Events > Data connectors > Connector details

Connector details

Windows Forwarded Events

Status: Disconnected | Provider: Microsoft | Last Log Received: --

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Last data received
--

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Author
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Related content
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Refresh

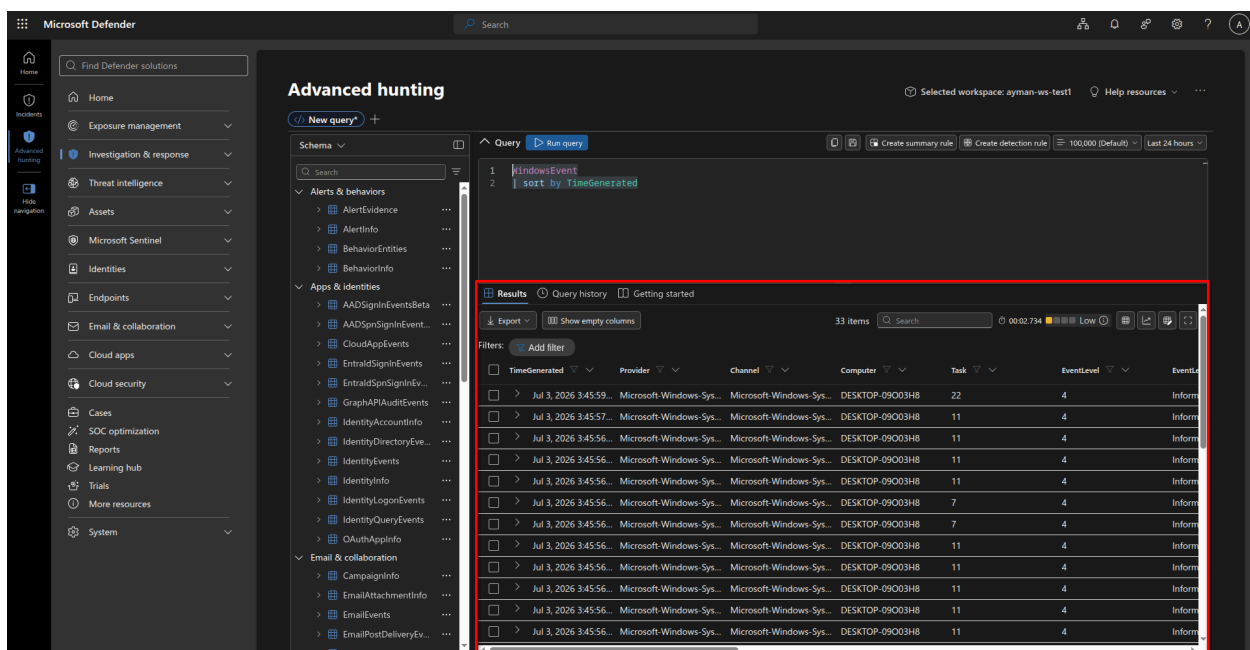
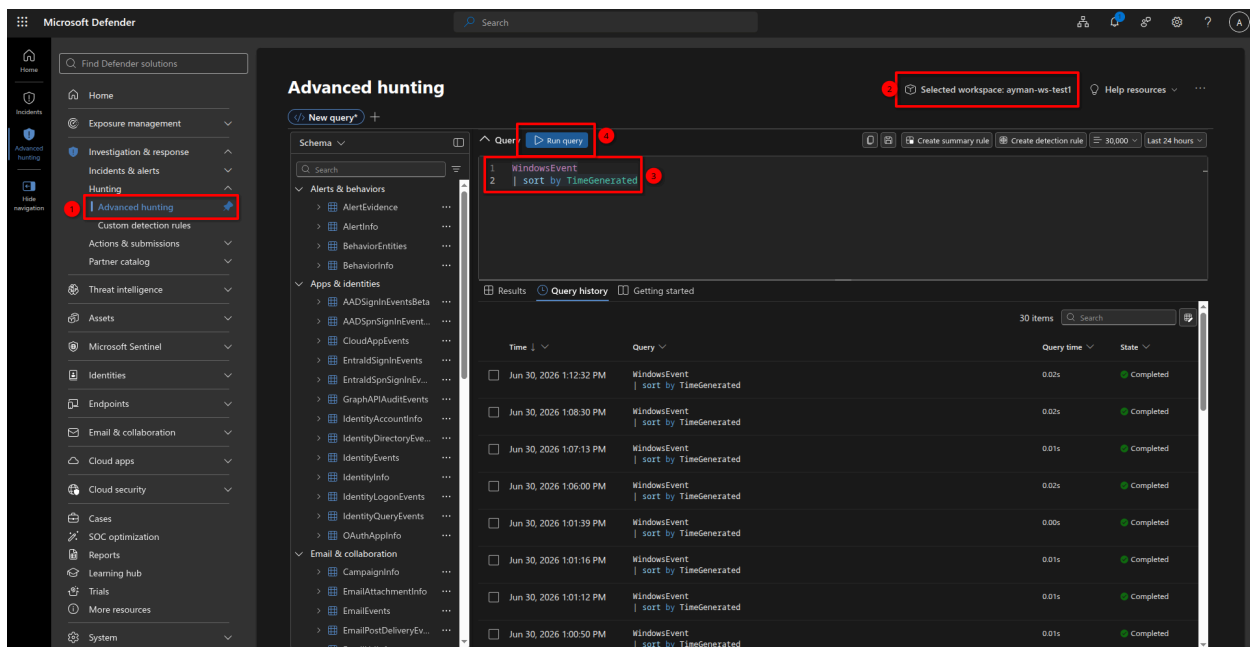
Rule name
collect-sysmon-logs

Created by
Sentinel

Filter name
Custom

Asim normalization support - Recommended!
This connector is supported by Asim. Learn more >
Deploy

The connector is now connected. Next, review the advanced options to ensure better coverage. Configure advanced options



7.2 Collect Windows Security Events

1. From **Content Hub**, install **Windows Security Events**.
2. Go to **Data Connectors** → **Windows Security Events**.
3. Create a DCR the same way as above, targeting the same machine.

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Windows Security Events

Status: All Content type: All Support: All Provider: All Category: All Content sources: All

Install/Update Delete

Content title	Status	Content source	Provider	Support
Windows Security Events	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Windows Security Events via AMA	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Security Events via Legacy Agent	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
NRT Security Event log cleared	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Suspicious Windows Login Outside Normal Ho...	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Windows System Time changed on hosts	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Windows System Shutdown/Reboot(Sysmon)	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Excessive Windows Logon Failures	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
NRT Base64 Encoded Windows Process Comm...	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
New EXE deployed via Default Domain or Defa...	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Gain Code Execution on ADFS Server via SMB ...	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Starting or Stopping HealthService to Avoid De...	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
Process Execution Frequency Anomaly	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...
AD FS Remote Auth Sync Connection	Not installed	Solution	Microsoft	Micro...

Windows Security Events

Microsoft Provider

Microsoft Support

3.0.12 Version

Description

Note: Please refer to the following before installing the solution:

- Review the solution [Release Notes](#)
- There may be [known issues](#) pertaining to this Solution, please refer to them before installing.

The Windows Security Events solution for Microsoft Sentinel allows you to ingest Security events from your Windows machines using the Windows Agent into Microsoft Sentinel. This solution includes two (2) data connectors to help ingest the logs.

- Windows Security Events via AMA** - This data connector helps in ingesting Security Events logs into your Log Analytics Workspace using the new Azure Monitor Agent. [Learn more about ingesting using the new Azure Monitor Agent here](#). **Microsoft recommends using this Data Connector.**
- Security Events via Legacy Agent** - This data connector helps in ingesting Security Events logs into your Log Analytics Workspace using the legacy Log Analytics agent.

Data Connectors: 2 Workbooks: 2 Analytic Rules: 20 Hunting Queries: 50

[Learn more about Microsoft Sentinel](#) | [Learn more about Solutions](#)

Content type

20 Analytics rule

2 Data connector

50 Hunting query

2 Workbook

Category

Security - Threat Protection

Pricing

Free

Install View details

Microsoft Defender

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Refresh Guides All workspaces

Device specific AMA connectors have been deprecated. [Learn more](#)

In anticipation of the End of Support of the HTTP Data Collector API, Azure Function-based data connectors using legacy API will not be supported after September 14, 2026. Please update to OCF-based data connectors. [Learn more](#)

4 Connectors 2 Connected More content at Content Hub

Search by name or provider Providers: Microsoft

Data Types: All Status: All

Status	Connector name	Updates
Connected	Microsoft 365 Insider Ri... Microsoft	...
Connected	Security Events via Lega... Microsoft	...
Connected	Windows Forwarded Eve... Microsoft	...
Disconnected	Windows Security Event... Microsoft	...

Windows Security Events via AMA

Disconnected Status

Microsoft Provider

Last Log Received

Description

You can stream all security events from the Windows machines connected to your Microsoft Sentinel workspace using the Windows agent. This connection enables you to view dashboards, create custom alerts, and improve investigation. This gives you more insight into your organization's network and improves your security operation capabilities.

Last data received

Content source

Windows Security Events

Version

1.0.0

Author

Microsoft

Supported by

Microsoft Corporation [Email]

Related content

0 Workbooks

1 Queries

20 Analytics rules templates

Data received

4

Go to log analytics

Open connector page

Connector details

Windows Security Events via AMA

Disconnected Status Microsoft Provider Last Log Received

Description: You can stream all security events from the Windows machines connected to your Microsoft Sentinel workspace using the Windows agent. This connection enables you to view dashboards, create custom alerts, and improve investigation. This gives you more insight into your organization's network and improves your security operation capabilities.

Last data received: --

Content source: Windows Security Events Version: 1.0.0

Author: Microsoft Supported by: Microsoft Corporation

Related content: 0 Workbooks, 1 Queries, 20 Analytics rules templates

Data received: Go to log analytics

SecurityEvents: 0

Data types: SecurityEvents

Prerequisites

To integrate with Windows Security Events via AMA make sure you have:

- ✓ **Workspace data sources:** read and write permissions.
- To collect data from non-Azure VMs, they must have Azure Arc installed and enabled. [Learn more](#)

Table management

Manage the table tiers - analytics and lake and table retention. Select the table to manage the table tier and configure its retention settings.

Table name	Tier	Table type	Analytics retention	Total retention	Workspace
SecurityEvent	Analytics	Sentinel	30 days	30 days	ayman-ws-test1

Configuration

Enable data collection rule

Security Events logs are collected only from **Windows** agents.

Refresh

Rule name Created by Filter name

No results

+ Create data collection rule

Connector details

Windows Security Events via AMA

Disconnected Status Microsoft Provider Last Log Received

Description: You can stream all security events from the Windows machines connected to your Microsoft Sentinel workspace using the Windows agent. This connection enables you to view dashboards, create custom alerts, and improve investigation. This gives you more insight into your organization's network and improves your security operation capabilities.

Last data received: --

Content source: Windows Security Events Version: 1.0.0

Author: Microsoft Supported by: Microsoft Corporation

Related content: 0 Workbooks, 1 Queries, 20 Analytics rules templates

Data received: Go to log analytics

SecurityEvents: 0

Data types: SecurityEvents

DCR Wizard

Basic Resources Collect Review > create

Select the subscription to manage deployed resources and costs. Use resource groups like folders to organize and manage all of your resources.

Rule details

Rule name: collect-security-events

Subscription: Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription...

Resource group: ayman-rg-test1

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Windows Security Events via AMA

Disconnected Status Microsoft Provider Last Log Received

Description

You can stream all security events from the Windows machines connected to your Microsoft Sentinel workspace using the Windows agent. This connection enables you to view dashboards, create custom alerts, and improve investigation. This gives you more insight into your organization's network and improves your security operation capabilities.

Last data received --

Content source Windows Security Events Version 1.0.0

Author Microsoft Supported by Microsoft Corporation | Email

Related content

0 Workbooks 1 Queries 20 Analytics rules templates

Data received

Go to log analytics

Security events

0

Setup Advanced options

DCR Wizard

Subscriptions Resource Groups Resource Types Locations

Selected: All Selected: All Selected: All Selected: All

Search to filter items... Show Selected

Scope Resource Type Location

Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription - MPN

ayman-rg-test1

DESKTOP-09003H8 microsoft.hybridcom Sweden Central

Enable data collection rule

Security Events logs are collected only from

Refresh

Rule name

No results

Create data collection rule

< Previous Next: Collect >

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Windows Security Events via AMA

Disconnected Status Microsoft Provider Last Log Received

Description

You can stream all security events from the Windows machines connected to your Microsoft Sentinel workspace using the Windows agent. This connection enables you to view dashboards, create custom alerts, and improve investigation. This gives you more insight into your organization's network and improves your security operation capabilities.

Last data received --

Content source Windows Security Events Version 1.0.0

Author Microsoft Supported by Microsoft Corporation | Email

Related content

0 Workbooks 1 Queries 20 Analytics rules templates

Data received

Go to log analytics

Security events

0

Setup Advanced options

DCR Wizard

Basic Resources Collect Review + create

Select which events to stream

All Security Events Common Minimal Custom

Enable data collection rule

Security Events logs are collected only from

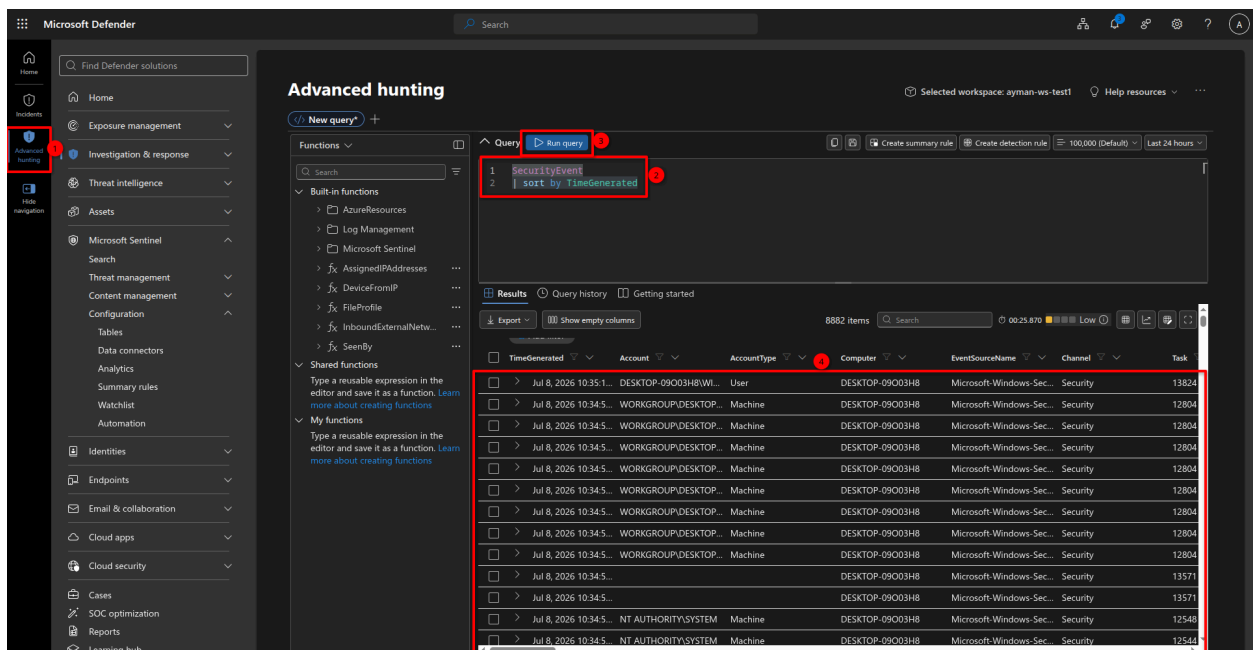
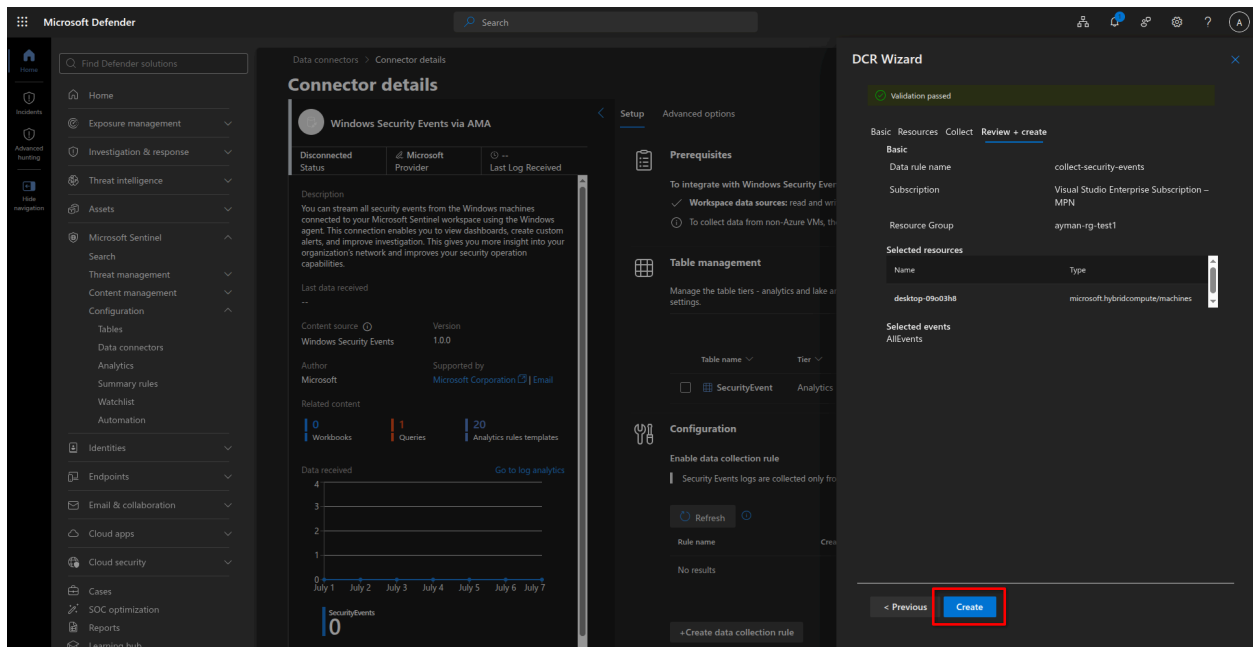
Refresh

Rule name

No results

Create data collection rule

< Previous Next: Review + create >



8. Verify Ingestion in Advanced Hunting

1. Go to **Advanced Hunting**, select your workspace.
2. Run a query against the relevant table (e.g. **DeviceEvents** / **Event** for Sysmon, **SecurityEvent** for Windows Security logs) to confirm data is flowing in. Ingestion can take a few minutes to appear.

Summary

Stage	Purpose
Sentinel Workspace	Central Log Analytics store backing Sentinel
Azure Arc	Brings the on-prem/VM machine under Azure management so DCRs can target it
Sysmon Install + Config	Generates rich, filtered telemetry on the endpoint
Content Hub + DCR (Sysmon)	Forwards Sysmon Operational log to the workspace
Content Hub + DCR (Security Events)	Forwards native Windows Security log to the workspace
Advanced Hunting	Confirms end-to-end ingestion via KQL